position. The negotiator of the other party is affected by the propaganda and at pains to avoid further confrontation in the talks. It is, therefore, advisable for the Indian interlocutor to openly call out such media reports and ask the Chinese side to clarify its view on record at the beginning of the talks, so that there is no pressure on the negotiator. The Chinese routinely follow this practice in any negotiation with India even though they are well aware that the media is independent in India.

China will also, on occasion, select the venue for the talks. The technique is called 'control on the ground'. The foreign negotiator is placed at a disadvantage by not being on home ground, but rather amidst unfamiliar working conditions, and this affects the negotiator's comfort level. [3] Thus, in 1950, China decided that India would have to come to them if it wanted diplomatic relations, and by summoning A.K. Sen from Nanjing to meet with them in Beijing, the Chinese fully controlled the environment for the interaction. The Chinese use this tactic especially in difficult negotiations, as it limits the ability of the Indian negotiator to consult in detail with the decision makers in the home country, and is an added psychological factor in China's favour. A variation on this theme is to hold meetings in venues outside Beijing. This is an attempt by the Chinese interlocutor to build a personal rapport with the opposite number in order to make her or him more amenable to the negotiation.

The Chinese prepare the field for negotiation in advance. For this, they use both diplomatic and more unorthodox means. Diplomatic means include the creation of new problems or obstacles just prior to the start of negotiations. In the 1954 negotiations over Tibet, the Chinese claimed that the Indian Trade Offices in Gyantse and Yadong were abetting the smuggling of arms. After the nuclear tests in 1998, the Chinese alleged that India was falsely spreading the 'China Threat'